

GCOLOTELA YOLA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Highly skilled and qualified Software Engineer and Network Engineer with practical experience in full-stack development, network architecture, and IT infrastructure. Currently interning at Mindspyr, a tech startup, where I contribute to innovative platforms including customer experience solutions, accommodation booking systems, and boardroom management tools. Hold a Diploma in Information Technology (Communication Networks Major) and CCNA certifications. Extensive experience in planning, implementing, and maintaining LAN and WAN infrastructures, with strong proficiency in modern web technologies (MERN stack, React Native), cloud platforms, and agile development methodologies.

EXPERIENCE

SOFTWARE ENGINEER INTERN

Mindspyr (Tech Startup), May 2024 – Present

- Collaborate in full-stack development across multiple products—designing interfaces, implementing RESTful APIs, and optimizing database interactions using MERN stack (MongoDB, Express.js, React, Node.js)
- Participate in agile workflows including daily stand-ups, sprint planning, code reviews, and deployment cycles on platforms such as Render.com, Oracle Cloud Platform, and Heroku
- Contributed to Hexaura, a customer experience platform, by conducting in-field testing with real customers, handling admin functionality, manufacturing physical components, and integrating performance metrics and coaching workflows
- Developed core features for nomadyQ, a reverse accommodation booking platform, including request submission flows, provider response systems, matching logic, and database schema design
- Led backend and frontend development for Delegat, a boardroom booking application, managing database design, API framework, deployment, and stakeholder presentations—now actively used by a company
- Assisted in prototyping and building frontend components and backend infrastructure for multiple upcoming product launches, taking on Technical Lead responsibilities
- Developed mobile applications using React Native and Expo with cross-platform compatibility
- Utilized Python scripting extensively for automation tasks including web scraping, integration, and data processing
- Configured and managed Virtual Communication Networks on Oracle Cloud Platform, assigned Virtual Machines, implemented SSH tunneling, and hosted websites and services
- Provided technical support for physical hardware including storage devices, RAM replacement and maintenance, while operating multiple OS environments via dual booting (Ubuntu, Linux Mint, Windows)
- Built and utilized AI and MCP (Model Context Protocol) tools to create comprehensive full-scale platforms with embedded solutions

EDUCATION

Diploma in Information Technology (Communication Networks Major)

Nelson Mandela University, 2020 - 2024

- Coursework: Software Development, Network Engineering, IT Support, Network Security
- Status: Pass, Completed
- Developed solid foundation in technical support, IT management, network security, infrastructure automation, Microsoft proficiency, and computer networks
- Programming skills: C#, Python, JavaScript/TypeScript

Matric (Grade 12)

Khanyisa High School, 2019

- Coursework: Mathematics, Physical Sciences, Life Sciences and Information Technology

SKILLS

Technical Skills:

Network Administration, Architecture, and Design
Full-Stack Development (MERN Stack)
Front-end: HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript/TypeScript, React, Bootstrap
Back-end: Node.js, Express.js, RESTful APIs
Database: SQL, MongoDB
Mobile Development: React Native, Expo
Cisco Equipment Configuration
Network Security
System Design and Implementation
LAN/WAN Configuration and Maintenance
VPNs, Virtual Hosts, Routers, Physical Hardware
Cloud Platforms: Oracle Cloud Platform, Heroku, Render.com
Infrastructure and Automation
Version Control: Git, GitHub
Programming Languages: Python, C#, C++, JavaScript/TypeScript
Agile Development Practices
CI/CD and Deployment Workflows

Soft Skills:

Analytical Thinking
Strong Communication Skills
Teamwork and Collaboration
Problem-Solving and Conflict Resolution
Attention to Detail
Able to Work Under Pressure
Adaptability and Flexibility
Critical Thinking and Decision-Making
Time Management
Leadership and Initiative
Effective Presentation Skills

PROJECTS

3-Tier Network Architecture (Cisco Packet Tracer Project)

- Developed a comprehensive 3-Tier Network Architecture to optimize network performance, security, and scalability. Details and configurations available upon request.

Hexaura - Customer Experience Platform

- Contributed to transforming frontline interactions into customer loyalty moments with real-time insights, performance metrics, and employee feedback loops

nomadyQ - Reverse Accommodation Booking Platform

- Developed core booking flows, backend APIs, and database architecture for innovative reverse-booking system where users post needs and accommodations respond

Delegat - Boardroom Booking Application

- Full-stack development and deployment of web-based booking system now in active production use, including database design, API development, and user training

CERTIFICATIONS

- CCNA Introduction to Networks
- CCNA Enterprise Networking, Security, Automation
- Currently obtaining A+ and N+ certifications

ACHIEVEMENTS & AWARDS

- Merit Award in Second Year (2021) for being one of the Top Achievers
- Multiple distinctions across different modules during Diploma program

LANGUAGES

- English, Zulu and IsiXhosa

REFERENCES

Available upon request